ALEX MORGAN

Lead DevOps & Site Reliability Engineer | Cloud Infrastructure Architect

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Analytical, performance-driven Lead DevOps & Cloud Platform Engineer with over 9 years of hands-on expertise architecting, deploying, and securing enterprise cloud infrastructure on AWS, Azure, and Google Cloud Platform. Specializes in Kubernetes orchestration at scale, declarative Infrastructure as Code (IaC) via Terraform, automated CI/CD pipelines, GitOps implementations, and comprehensive observability systems. Proven track record reducing deployment failure rates by 74%, driving annual cloud expenditure down by 38%, and maintaining five-nines (99.999%) SLA uptime for mission-critical distributed microservices. Recognized for robust disaster recovery engineering, zero-trust security postures, and enabling high-velocity engineering cultures.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Cloud Platforms	Amazon Web Services (AWS - EKS, ECS, Lambda, IAM, VPC, S3, RDS, CloudFront), Microsoft Azure (AKS, App Services, Blob, Azure DevOps), GCP (GKE, Cloud Functions)
Container & Orchestration	Kubernetes (k8s), Docker, Helm, Docker Compose, Istio Service Mesh, Linkerd, Containerd, CRI-O, KEDA (Kubernetes Event-driven Autoscaling)
Infrastructure as Code	Terraform, Terragrunt, AWS CloudFormation, Pulumi, Ansible, Packer, Bash Scripting, Python (boto3, automation scripts)
CI/CD & GitOps	GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Jenkins Enterprise, ArgoCD, FluxCD, Spinnaker, CircleCI, Nexus, Artifactory
Observability & Telemetry	Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana), AWS CloudWatch, Jaeger, OpenTelemetry, New Relic
Security & Compliance	HashiCorp Vault, SonarQube, Snyk, Aqua Security, Trivy, Falco, CIS Benchmarks, SOC2 Type II, ISO 27001, OIDC/OAuth2 Integration
Networking & Storage	TCP/IP, DNS, Route 53, NGINX Ingress Controller, Traefik, HAProxy, Envoy, Cloudflare, Ceph, NFS, EBS, EFS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Staff DevOps Engineer & Platform Architect

Oct 2023 – Present

Apex FinTech Cloud Solutions *| Seattle, WA (Remote)*

- Architected multi-region AWS EKS infrastructure serving 8M daily financial transactions with zero downtime multi-cluster failover mechanisms.
- Engineered automated GitOps deployment workflows using ArgoCD and GitHub Actions, cutting mean deployment cycle times from 45 minutes to 4.2 minutes across 65 microservices.
- Implemented FinOps governance using Kubecost and AWS Cost Explorer, eliminating idle container capacity and securing $420,000 in annualized AWS infrastructure savings.
- Designed unified OpenTelemetry observability pipeline streaming custom metrics and distributed tracing data into Datadog, cutting MTTR for production anomalies by 58%.
- Enforced Shift-Left DevSecOps automation incorporating Snyk container scanning and HashiCorp Vault dynamic credential rotation into core delivery pipelines.

Senior DevOps / SRE Engineer

Feb 2021 – Sep 2023

HyperScale Systems Inc. *| San Francisco, CA*

- Led the container migration of a monolithic e-commerce application into 40+ containerized microservices managed on hybrid Kubernetes environments.
- Standardized company-wide Infrastructure as Code (IaC) libraries using modular Terraform and Terragrunt across staging, UAT, and production environments.
- Established chaos engineering testing using Chaos Mesh to validate auto-healing, load-balancer failovers, and RDS cross-region replication strategies.
- Formulated and maintained production SLOs, SLAs, and SLIs in collaboration with product managers, consistently achieving 99.99% system availability targets.
- Automated database migration scripts and blue/green deployment orchestration strategies on Aurora PostgreSQL, avoiding maintenance outage windows.

DevOps / Cloud Operations Engineer

Jul 2018 – Jan 2021

Vanguard Digital Media *| Austin, TX*

- Maintained scalable AWS infrastructure supporting high-traffic streaming services utilizing EC2 Auto Scaling Groups, CloudFront CDN, and S3 data lakes.
- Built scalable Jenkins pipelines for continuous builds, automated unit/integration testing, and packaging of Docker container images to Amazon ECR.
- Configured Prometheus server monitors, Alertmanager paging policies, and curated Grafana operations dashboards for infrastructure and database telemetry.
- Authored reusable Ansible playbooks for automated host provisioning, operating system hardening, and patch management across 250+ Linux nodes.
- Participated in weekly 24/7 on-call rotations, responding to P1/P2 incidents and publishing detailed root cause analysis (RCA) post-mortems.

Junior Systems Administrator / Build Engineer

Jun 2016 – Jun 2018

Nexus Software Labs *| Dallas, TX*

- Administered internal Linux (RHEL/Ubuntu) and Windows development servers, directory services (LDAP/Active Directory), and local network firewalls.
- Automated recurring server maintenance, system log rotation, and disk cleanup tasks using custom Bash and Python shell scripts.
- Supported software engineering teams by troubleshooting staging build failures, Git merge conflicts, and dependency repository issues.

HIGHLIGHTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Multi-Region Active-Active Kubernetes Disaster Recovery Fabric

Stack: AWS EKS, Terraform, Route53, ExternalDNS, Cilium Service Mesh, Velero, ArgoCD

Spearheaded the technical architecture of an automated disaster recovery (DR) architecture across AWS us-east-1 and us-west-2 regions. Implemented real-time etcd snapshotting, Velero cluster backup automation, and DNS health-check-driven failover. Reduced RPO (Recovery Point Objective) from 4 hours to less than 90 seconds and achieved an RTO (Recovery Time Objective) under 3 minutes during disaster simulation drills.

Enterprise Internal Developer Platform (IDP) & Self-Service Portal

Stack: Backstage (Spotify), Kubernetes, Helm, Crossplane, GitHub Actions, Terraform Cloud

Constructed a self-service internal developer platform leveraging Spotify Backstage and Crossplane. Empowered over 180 software developers to provision ephemeral preview environments, cloud databases, and CI/CD pipelines via declarative golden templates, reducing developer onboarding time from 14 business days down to 2 hours.

Automated Cloud FinOps Engine & Workload Rightsizing Framework

Stack: Python, AWS SDK (Boto3), Kubecost, Karpenter, Prometheus, Grafana, Slack API

Engineered an event-driven cluster auto-scaler using Karpenter and custom Python serverless lambdas that dynamically migrated spot instances and downsized non-production Kubernetes deployments outside business hours. Generated quantifiable annual savings of $310,000 while maintaining 100% test pipeline reliability.

Zero-Trust Cloud Network Migration & Workload Identity Federation

Stack: HashiCorp Vault, AWS IAM Roles for Service Accounts (IRSA), Istio mTLS, SPIFFE/SPIRE

Deprecating long-lived static AWS IAM access keys in favor of dynamic OIDC credential issuance via HashiCorp Vault and Kubernetes IRSA. Enforced end-to-end mutual TLS (mTLS) across all inter-service cluster communications using Istio, aligning platform security posture with SOC2 Type II compliance benchmarks.

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

Certification Name	Issuing Organization	Credential ID / Status	Validity
AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (SAP-C02)	Amazon Web Services	AWS-PSA-8941038	Active (Exp: 2027)
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)	Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF)	CKA-2200-847291	Active (Exp: 2026)
Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS)	Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF)	CKS-3100-908123	Active (Exp: 2026)
HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate (003)	HashiCorp	HC-TA-582910	Active (Exp: 2025)
Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE) - Ansible Automation	Red Hat Inc.	RHCE-180-49210	Certified

KEY CAREER ACHIEVEMENTS & RECOGNITIONS

- **Infrastructure Modernization Award (2024):** Conferred company-wide engineering excellence recognition for successfully migrating 120 production databases to AWS Aurora Serverless without customer impact.
- **Global On-Call Resilience Optimization:** Re-engineered incident alert thresholds and automated auto-remediation scripts, reducing low-severity pager fatigue alerts by 67%.
- **Author & Speaker:** Delivered technical sessions on "Zero-Trust Architecture on Kubernetes" at Pacific Northwest Cloud Native Summit and regional DevOps meetup groups.
- **Open Source Contributor:** Regular contributor to CNCF ecosystem projects, including PR contributions to Kubernetes Helm charts, Karpenter documentation, and Terraform AWS modules.

EDUCATION & ACADEMIC BACKGROUND

Degree & Major	Institution	Location	Graduation Year
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (BSCS)	University of Washington, College of Engineering	Seattle, WA	2016
Specialized Coursework: Distributed Systems, Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Algorithm Design	Academic Dean's Honors List	GPA: 3.82 / 4.0	2012 – 2016